

DECA Individual Series Events

Individual Series Events are individual member events that pose business challenges with role-plays set in specialized career areas. Please keep in mind the example scenarios listed below are intended to help DECA members understand the types of scenarios they may be faced with in the particular roleplay selected. However, actual roleplays are much more in depth. If you would like to see a full roleplay for any of the events listed below please visit [Deca.org](https://deca.org) and search by event. Then select, "Sample event".

Human Resources Management Series (HRM):

Test: Business Management and Administration

Potential Topics Addressed: Management functions and tasks focusing on staffing, recruitment, selection, training, performance appraisal, compensation and safety training.

Example Scenario: Develop a system to collect customer feedback on employee performance and create a program to reward outstanding customer service.

Apparel and Accessories Marketing Series (AAM):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks in retail establishments, wholesale establishments and/or manufacturing firms primarily engaged in the marketing of clothing and related articles for personal wear and adornment.

Example Scenario: Recommend changes to a retailer's order pickup and return procedures to prevent fraud.

Automotive Services Marketing Series (ASM):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks related to auto dealers, service stations and related businesses or auto parts stores.

Example Scenario: Develop a promotional campaign to introduce a new self-driving rideshare service and build customer trust before its launch.

Sports and Entertainment Marketing Series (SEM):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks related to amateur or professional sports or sporting events, entertainment or entertainment events, selling or renting of supplies and equipment (other than vehicles) used for recreational or sporting purposes, products and services related to hobbies or cultural events, or businesses primarily engaged in satisfying the desire to make productive or enjoyable use of leisure time.

Example Scenario: Develop short-term sales incentives to increase online ticket purchases for a live entertainment event.

Business Services Marketing Series (BSM):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing functions and tasks involved in providing services to businesses on a fee or contract basis or providing services to consumers.

Example Scenario: Recommend a new product or service that helps a shipping store attract new customers and stand out from competitors.

Food Marketing Series (FMS):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks in retail establishments, wholesale establishments and manufacturing firms resulting in the sale of food.

Example Scenario: Create a communication campaign to warn customers about fake restaurant websites and delivery scams while protecting your restaurant's reputation.

Marketing Communications Series (MCS):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing communications and marketing functions and tasks that inform, persuade, or remind a target market of ideas, experiences, goods or services.

Example Scenario: Develop a social media campaign around a national holiday to increase engagement and attract younger customers.

Retail Merchandising Series (RMS):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks that can be applied in any retail establishment.

Example Scenario: Plan a themed bookstore event inspired by a popular social media trend to attract younger customers and increase sales.

Entrepreneurship Series (ENT):

Test: Entrepreneurship

Potential Topics Addressed: Recognizing opportunities, determining needs, identifying markets, utilizing market research, identifying sources of capital and use of management skills.

Example Scenario: Analyze a change in target customers and adjust products and services to better meet the needs of the new market.

Accounting Applications Series (ACT):

Test: Finance

Potential Topics Addressed: Perform management functions and tasks focusing on the application of financial data to business planning, including collection and organization of data, development and use of reports, and analysis of data to make business decisions. Concepts include understanding the source and purpose of financial statements, the impact of management decisions on statements, and the analysis and interpretation of data for planning.

Example Scenario: Analyze business transactions, create a balance sheet, and explain how financial activities impact the accounting equation for a coffee shop.

Business Finance Series (BFS):

Test: Finance

Potential Topics Addressed: Management functions and tasks focusing on high-level financial and business planning, including collection and organization of data, development and use of reports, and analysis of data to make business decisions. Concepts include understanding the source and purpose of financial statements, the impact of management decisions on statements, and the analysis and interpretation of data for corporate planning.

Example Scenario: Analyze financial ratios to determine a company's working capital cycle and explain how improving collections affects cash flow.

Hotel and Lodging Management Series (HLM):

Test: Hospitality and Tourism

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks in hotels, motels, lodging services, convention services, and food and beverage services.

Example Scenario: Develop a community marketing event that increases awareness of a new lodge and creates future booking opportunities.

Quick Serve Restaurant Management Series (QSRM):

Test: Hospitality and Tourism

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks in retail establishments, wholesale establishments and manufacturing firms primarily engaged in the quick-serve restaurant industry.

Example Scenario: Develop a marketing strategy for BOBA STOP to introduce bubble tea to older customers and increase its customer base.

Restaurant and Food Service Management Series (RFSM):

Test: Hospitality and Tourism

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks in a full-service restaurant or a food-service business.

Example Scenario: Develop a customer appreciation strategy for BIG TIME, a family owned restaurant, to honor military members and veterans without offering free meals.

DECA Professional Selling Events

Professional Selling Events are competed at the district level competition (if qualified you can move on to both State and ICDC however). These events are prepared beforehand. They are somewhere between a roleplay and a written one. In these events you will assume the role of a sales person for a company. You are welcome to use a visual aid like a slide show during your presentation. For more information visit Deca.org or reach out to Scarlett (804466@dpsk12.net or 720-788-3667).

Financial Consulting (FCE)

Test: Finance

This Year's Prompt: For 2026-2027, you will assume the role of a financial consultant meeting with a small-business owner in their late 50's who is beginning to think about retirement and succession planning. The client wants to explore options for selling, transferring, or winding down their business while maximizing financial security.

Professional Selling (PSE) -> This is considered the marketing event

Test: Marketing

This Year's Prompt: For 2026-2027, you will assume the role of a sales representative for a company that offers an integrated platform combining AI-powered customer service tools and retail analytics. A regional retail chain owner has scheduled a meeting to learn how your solution can reduce response times, lower staffing costs, optimize inventory, and improve the overall customer experience both in-store and online. Your goal is to explain how your platform can help the business operate more efficiently while increasing customer satisfaction and sales.

Hospitality and Tourism Professional Selling (HTPS)

Test: Hospitality and Tourism

This Year's Prompt: For 2026-2027, you will assume the role of a sales representative for a tour wholesaler that designs immersive, experience-based group travel packages (culinary tours, cultural immersions, adventure itineraries). A local travel agency is looking to move away from traditional group bus tours and wants to modernize its offerings for younger travelers.

DECA Team Decision Making Events

Team Decision Making Events challenge a team of two participants to analyze a case study in a specific career area and develop a solution. Please keep in mind the example scenarios listed below are intended to help DECA members understand the types of scenarios they may be faced with in the particular roleplay selected. However, actual roleplays are much more in depth. If you would like to see a full roleplay for any of the events listed below please visit Deca.org and search by event. Then select, "Sample event".

Business Law and Ethics Team Decision Making (BLTDM):

Test: Business Management and Administration

Potential Topics Addressed: U.S. law, contracts, product liability, employment and types of business ownership. The ethics component involves evaluating competing social values.

Example Scenario: Recommend changes to a popular restaurant promotion that has become too costly while preserving customer loyalty.

Buying and Merchandising Team Decision Making (BTDM):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Get product to the hands of the customer through forecasting, planning, buying, displaying, selling and providing customer service.

Example Scenario: Develop an exclusive brand partnership where a popular brand creates a product that is sold only at your retail store to attract high school customers, and explain how you would promote it.

Marketing Management Team Decision Making (MTDM):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing, management

Example Scenario: Analyze whether a nonprofit thrift store should raise prices to increase funding while considering the impact on different customer groups and the community.

Sports and Entertainment Marketing Team Decision Making (STDM):

Test: Marketing

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing functions and tasks that can be applied in amateur or professional sports or sporting events, entertainment or entertainment events, selling or renting of supplies and equipment (other than vehicles) used for recreational or sporting purposes or products and services related to hobbies, leisure or cultural events.

Example Scenario: Develop a promotional campaign to increase attendance at a local baseball team's games by using the popularity of a trending sports documentary or TV series.

Entrepreneurship Team Decision Making (ETDM)

Test: Entrepreneurship

Potential Topics Addressed: Recognizing opportunities, determining needs, identifying markets, utilize marketing research, identify sources of capital and use management skills.

Example Scenario: Recommend an additional service for a laundromat that keeps customers engaged during wait times and increases business.

Financial Services Team Decision Making (FTDM)

Test: Finance

Potential Topics Addressed: The source and purpose of financial statements, the impact of management decisions on statements, and the analysis and interpretation of data for planning purposes.

Example Scenario: Advise a young family on how to save, invest, manage risk, and build long-term financial security.

Hospitality Services Team Decision Making (HTDM):

Test: Hospitality and Tourism

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions and tasks that can be applied in hotels, motels, lodging services, convention services, and food and beverage services.

Example Scenario: Recommend a reservation strategy that gives hotel guests better access to a high-demand restaurant.

Travel and Tourism Team Decision Making (TTDM):

Test: Hospitality and Tourism

Potential Topics Addressed: Marketing and management functions for passenger transportation, travel service, attracting and serving the traveling public, arranging tours or acting as independent ticket agencies, and other services incidental to the travel or tourism industry.

Example Scenario: Recommend policy changes for an airport lounge to improve customer relations, reduce overcrowding, and strengthen the brand.

DECA Principles Events

Principles of Business Administration Events are for first-year DECA members. The member is asked to explain several core business concepts. Please keep in mind the example scenarios listed below are intended to help DECA members understand the types of scenarios they may be faced with in the particular roleplay selected. However, actual roleplays are much more in depth. If you would like to see a full roleplay for any of the events listed below please visit Deca.org and search by event. Then select, "Sample event".

Principles of Business Management and Administration (PBM):

Test: Business Administration Core

Careers: Administrative services, business information management, general management, human resources management, and operations management

Example Scenario: A customer is upset because the City of Logan no longer accepts cash payments for water bills, and you must explain the new policy professionally.

Principles of Entrepreneurship (PEN):

Test: Business Administration Core

Careers: Entrepreneur, small business owner

Example Scenario: As the owner of a coffee shop, explain how you will collect, manage, and use customer feedback and online reviews.

Principles of Finance (PFN):

Test: Business Administration Core

Careers: Accounting, banking services, business finance, insurance and securities, and investments

Example Scenario: Train a new bank employee on security procedures, customer privacy, and protecting sensitive information.

Principles of Hospitality and Tourism (PHT):

Test: Business Administration Core

Careers: Involvement in hotels, restaurants, and tourism and travel.

Example Scenario: Explain to a coworker how rising food costs affect menu prices and restaurant profits.

Principles of Marketing (PMK):

Test: Business Administration Core

Careers: Marketing communications, marketing management, marketing research, merchandising and professional selling.

Example Scenario: Develop a marketing campaign to increase winter sales at an ice cream shop.